

ASIA'S TITANS TAKE THE TABLE IN ODISHA

Odisha, traditionally celebrated for its rich tapestry of art, culture, and temples, is now emerging as India's premier sporting destination. The state is strategically investing in world-class infrastructure, athlete development, and hosting international events to transform into a global sporting hub.

Following the successful hosting of the World Athletics Continental Tour Bronze in August, Odisha is all set to have another landmark moment as it welcomes the 28th ITTF-ATTU Asian Table Tennis (Team) Championships 2025. The prestigious event will be held at the Kalinga Stadium from October 11 to 15. The championship, returning to India after 16 years, will bring together 22 nations, over 500 players and support staff, and top officials from the Asian Table Tennis Union (ATTU). Asian powerhouses China, Japan, and Korea will field their strong squads, while teams from Central, South-East, and West Asia compete for the 12 remaining continental qualification slots for the 2026 World Team Championships in London. India's men's and women's teams, having already secured qualification through last month's South Asian Regional Championships in Kathmandu, will witness intense competition for these coveted positions.

Adding prestige to the event, India's table tennis legend Padma Shri A. Sharath Kamal, a multiple Commonwealth, Asian Games medallist and Khel Ratna awardee, has been named Brand Ambassador. Sharath expressed his honor in promoting the championship, inspiring young athletes, and showcasing India's world-class sporting potential.



Highlighting Odisha's readiness, Sports Minister Shri Suryabanshi Suraj confirmed that world-class infrastructure, accommodation, hospitality, and security are in place. TTFI President Shri Kamlesh Mehta expressed confidence that Odisha would deliver a seamless championship, reinforcing the state's position as a premier global sporting destination. With the state also hosting the 40th National Junior Athletics Championships and the ITF Masters 100 Tennis Tournament, Odisha is demonstrating its unmatched capacity to stage multiple sports events simultaneously.

Hosting the 28th ITTF-ATTU Asian Table Tennis Championships in Bhubaneswar offers an opportunity to highlight both sporting excellence and organizational precision. Beyond demonstrating Odisha's passion for sports and world-class hospitality, the event serves as a platform to strengthen the state's sports ecosystem and inspire the next generation with the right kind of exposure. The tournament underscores Odisha's emergence as a prominent venue for international events, reflecting the state's dedication in nurturing talent, delivering world-class infrastructure, and fostering the growth of sports at every level.